18.11 Alcohol Withdrawal

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My hands shake and I see insects on the wall." **Objective** • Shaking, sweating, HR 118/min • Seeing things that are not there • Last drink 48 hours ago	**ACTUAL** **Acute substance withdrawal syndrome** related to abrupt cessation of alcohol as evidenced by tremor, tachycardia and hallucinations.	Gets through withdrawal with no seizures and no delirium.	• Score the withdrawal with a validated scale (CIWA-Ar, for example). • Give benzodiazepines as prescribed, according to the score. • Give thiamine before any glucose, as prescribed. • Watch vital signs and level of consciousness.	Withdrawal safe: **goal met**.
Subjective • "There are people in my room." **Objective** • Disoriented at night • Hallucinating	**ACTUAL** **Acute confusion** related to alcohol withdrawal as evidenced by disorientation and hallucinations.	Oriented within 72 hours.	• Keep his room well lit and quiet. • Reorient him often. • Keep him under close observation.	Oriented: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Drinks heavily • Has had seizures in withdrawal before	**RISK** **Risk for injury** as evidenced by risk factors: withdrawal seizures and confusion.	No injury.	• Seizure precautions in place. • Fall precautions in place. • Give the benzodiazepine according to the score, as prescribed.	No injury: **goal met**.